Formulations for the finite element method and the GetDP software

Marc Boulé
marc.boule@etsmtl.ca

November 3, 2026

This document presents a set of formulations based on the Laplace/Poisson equations for use in the finite element method. Implementation notes for the GetDP software are also briefly given. Electromagnetic notation mostly follows the textbook "*Introduction to electrodynamics*" by D. J. Griffiths. The symbol i is the imaginary unit, and phasors are denoted $\tilde{\mathbf{A}}$, with $\mathbf{A}(t) = \mathrm{Re}[\tilde{\mathbf{A}}e^{i\omega t}]$.

The simulation domain is denoted Ω, and its boundary is denoted Γ. The Neumann-type portion of the domain's boundary, if required, is denoted Γ_N. The Dirichlet-type portion of the domain's boundary, if required, is denoted Γ_D. Each can be subdivided into multiple disjoint subregions, but are treated as a single type for the sake of simplicity. Thus, $\Gamma = \Gamma_D \cup \Gamma_N$.

All weighting functions (sometimes called test functions) are denoted W or $\mathbf{W}$. In the numerical implementation, it is assumed that $W = 0$ or $\mathbf{n}\times\mathbf{W} = \mathbf{0}$ on Γ_D. The unit vector $\mathbf{n}$ is normal to Γ and points outward. All material parameters such as permittivity, permeability, electric or thermal conductivity, are assumed to be scalar values.

The following formulations appear in this document:

1 Newtonian gravitation – Scalar potential
2 Electrostatics – Scalar potential
3 Magnetostatics – Scalar potential
4 Magnetostatics – Vector potential
5 Electrokinetics – Scalar potential
6 Thermal conduction – Scalar potential
7 Potential flow – Scalar potential
8 Magnetoquasistatics – Vector and scalar potentials

1 Newtonian gravitation – Scalar potential

Simple gravitation not involving general relativity.

		Governing law:
		$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{g} = -4\pi G\rho$
$\mathbf{g} = -\nabla V$	$[\mathrm{N} \cdot \mathrm{kg}^{-1}]$	Gravitational field (gravitational acceleration)
V	$[\mathrm{N} \cdot \mathrm{m} \cdot \mathrm{kg}^{-1}]$	Gravitational potential ($V \leq 0$)
G	$[\mathrm{N} \cdot \mathrm{m}^2 \cdot \mathrm{kg}^{-2}]$	Universal gravitational constant
ρ	$[\mathrm{kg} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-3}]$	Mass density
		Strong form:
		$\nabla \cdot (\nabla V) = 4\pi G\rho$
		Weak form:
		$\int_\Omega \nabla V \cdot \nabla W \, d\Omega + \int_{\Gamma_N} \mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{g} \, W \, d\Gamma_N + 4\pi G \int_\Omega \rho \, W \, d\Omega = 0$
$V = 0$	on Γ_D, homogeneous Dirichlet (normal $\mathbf{g}$)	
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{g} = 0$	on Γ_N, homogeneous Neumann (tangent $\mathbf{g}$)	
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{g} = g_{n,N}(\mathbf{r})$	on Γ_N, nonhomogeneous Neumann (normal component of gravitational field, positive when field exits Ω, negative when field enters Ω)	
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{g} = V/R$	on Γ_N, first order asymptotic boundary condition (3D/axisym.)	
		Post-processing:
$W_g = \frac{-1}{8\pi G} \int g^2 \, d\Omega$	[J]	Gravitational energy

2 Electrostatics – Scalar potential

Permanent polarization $\mathbf{P}_p$ is included but can be set to $\mathbf{0}$ when not needed.

		Governing law:
		$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{D} = \rho$
$\mathbf{D}$	$[\mathrm{C} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-2}]$	Electric displacement field
ρ	$[\mathrm{C} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-3}]$	Free charge density
		Constitutive relation:
		$\mathbf{D} = \varepsilon \mathbf{E} + \mathbf{P}_p$
$\varepsilon = \varepsilon_r \varepsilon_0$	$[\mathrm{C}^2 \cdot \mathrm{N}^{-1} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-2}]$	Electric permittivity of medium
ε_0	$[\mathrm{C}^2 \cdot \mathrm{N}^{-1} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-2}]$	Vacuum permittivity
ε_r	[1]	Relative permittivity of medium
$\mathbf{E} = -\nabla V$	$[\mathrm{V} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-1}]$	Electric field
V	[V]	Electric potential
$\mathbf{P}_p$	$[\mathrm{C} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-2}]$	Permanent polarization of medium
		Strong form:
		$-\nabla \cdot \left(\varepsilon \nabla V + \mathbf{P}_p \right) = \rho$
		Weak form:
		$\int_\Omega \varepsilon \nabla V \cdot \nabla W \, d\Omega - \int_\Omega \mathbf{P}_p \cdot \nabla W \, d\Omega + \int_{\Gamma_N} \mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{D} \, W \, d\Gamma_N - \int_\Omega \rho \, W \, d\Omega = 0$
$V = V_D$		on Γ_D, constant Dirichlet (normal $\mathbf{E}$; normal $\mathbf{D}$ when normal $\mathbf{P}_p$); charge Q [C] is the associated (dual) global quantity for a floating potential
$V = V_D(\mathbf{r})$		on Γ_D, nonhomogeneous Dirichlet (general case)
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{D} = 0$		on Γ_N, homogeneous Neumann (tangent $\mathbf{D}$; tangent $\mathbf{E}$ when tangent $\mathbf{P}_p$)
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{D} = -\sigma_N(\mathbf{r})$		on Γ_N, nonhomogeneous Neumann (prescribed surface charge density)
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{D} = m\varepsilon_0 V / R$		on Γ_N, first order asymptotic boundary condition, $m = 1$ for 2D planar without net charge or 3D/axisym. with net charge, $m = 2$ for 3D/axisym. without net charge
		Post-processing:
$W_E = \frac{1}{2} \int \varepsilon E^2 \, d\Omega$	[J]	Electrostatic energy
$W_D = \frac{1}{2} \int \frac{1}{\varepsilon} D^2 \, d\Omega$	[J]	Electrostatic coenergy (equal to energy when $\mathbf{P}_p = \mathbf{0}$)

3 Magnetostatics – Scalar potential

This formulation is applicable when no free currents exist. Permanent magnetization $\mathbf{M}_p$ is included but can be set to $\mathbf{0}$ when not needed. The quantity $\mu_0\mathbf{M}_p$ represents the remanent magnetic field in the magnet (called $\mathbf{B}_r$). Linear permanent magnets are sometimes specified by their coercive $\mathbf{H}$ field instead (called $\mathbf{H}_c$). The equalities below can be invoked as needed:

$$\mu_0\mathbf{M}_p = \mathbf{B}_r = \mu\mathbf{H}_c \tag{1}$$

	Governing law:	
	$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{B} = 0$	
$\mathbf{B}$	[T]	Magnetic field
	Constitutive relation:	
	$\mathbf{B} = \mu\mathbf{H} + \mu_0\mathbf{M}_p$	
$\mu = \mu_r\mu_0$	$[\mathrm{T}\cdot\mathrm{m}\cdot\mathrm{A}^{-1}]$	Magnetic permeability of medium
μ_0	$[\mathrm{T}\cdot\mathrm{m}\cdot\mathrm{A}^{-1}]$	Vacuum permeability
μ_r	[1]	Relative permeability of medium
$\mathbf{H} = -\nabla\varphi$	$[\mathrm{A}\cdot\mathrm{m}^{-1}]$	Auxiliary field
φ	[A]	Magnetic scalar potential
$\mathbf{M}_p$	$[\mathrm{A}\cdot\mathrm{m}^{-1}]$	Permanent magnetization of medium
	Strong form:	
	$-\nabla\cdot\left(\mu\nabla\varphi + \mu_0\mathbf{M}_p\right) = 0$	
	Weak form:	
	$\int_\Omega \mu\nabla\varphi\cdot\nabla W\,d\Omega - \int_\Omega \mu_0\mathbf{M}_p\cdot\nabla W\,d\Omega + \int_{\Gamma_N}\mathbf{n}\cdot\mathbf{B}\,W\,d\Gamma_N = 0$	
$\varphi = \varphi_D$	on Γ_D, constant Dirichlet (normal $\mathbf{H}$; normal $\mathbf{B}$ when normal $\mathbf{M}_p$)	
$\varphi = \varphi_D(\mathbf{r})$	on Γ_D, nonhomogeneous Dirichlet (general case)	
$\mathbf{n}\cdot\mathbf{B} = 0$	on Γ_N, homogeneous Neumann (tangent $\mathbf{B}$; tangent $\mathbf{H}$ when tangent $\mathbf{M}_p$)	
$\mathbf{n}\cdot\mathbf{B} = -\sigma_N(\mathbf{r})$	on Γ_N, nonhomogeneous Neumann (fictitious magnetic surface charge density)	
$\mathbf{n}\cdot\mathbf{B} = m\mu_0\varphi/R$	on Γ_N, first order asymptotic boundary condition, $m = 1$ for 2D planar, $m = 2$ for 3D/axisymmetric (no net magnetic charge, i.e. no magnetic monopoles)	
	Post-processing:	
$W_H = \frac{1}{2}\int \mu H^2\,d\Omega$	[J]	Magnetostatic energy
$W_B = \frac{1}{2}\int \frac{1}{\mu}B^2\,d\Omega$	[J]	Magnetostatic coenergy (equal to energy when $\mathbf{M}_p = \mathbf{0}$)

The correspondance between the electrostatic scalar formulation (without free charges) and the magnetostatic scalar formulation is

$$\mathbf{D}\leftrightarrow\mathbf{B} \qquad \mathbf{E}\leftrightarrow\mathbf{H} \qquad \mathbf{P}_p\leftrightarrow\mu_0\mathbf{M}_p \qquad \varepsilon_0\leftrightarrow\mu_0 \qquad \varepsilon_r\leftrightarrow\mu_r \qquad \varepsilon\leftrightarrow\mu \tag{2}$$

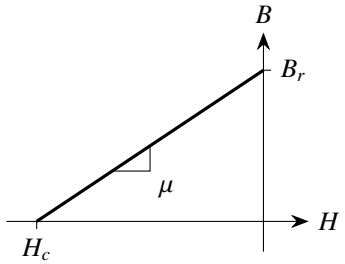
4 Magnetostatics – Vector potential

This formulation is required when free currents exist. Permanent magnetization $\mathbf{M}_p$ is included but can be set to $\mathbf{0}$ when not needed. The quantity $\mu_0\mathbf{M}_p$ represents the remanent magnetic field in the magnet (called $\mathbf{B}_r$). Linear permanent magnets are sometimes specified by their coercive $\mathbf{H}$ field instead (called $\mathbf{H}_c$). The equalities below can be invoked as needed:

$$\mu_0\mathbf{M}_p = \mathbf{B}_r = \mu\mathbf{H}_c \tag{3}$$

	Governing law:	
	$\nabla \times \mathbf{H} = \mathbf{J}$	
$\mathbf{H}$	$[\mathrm{A}\cdot\mathrm{m}^{-1}]$	Auxiliary field
$\mathbf{J}$	$[\mathrm{A}\cdot\mathrm{m}^{-2}]$	Free current density
	Constitutive relation:	
	$\mathbf{B} = \mu\mathbf{H} + \mu_0\mathbf{M}_p$	
$\mu = \mu_r\mu_0$	$[\mathrm{T}\cdot\mathrm{m}\cdot\mathrm{A}^{-1}]$	Magnetic permeability of medium
μ_0	$[\mathrm{T}\cdot\mathrm{m}\cdot\mathrm{A}^{-1}]$	Vacuum permeability
μ_r	[1]	Relative permeability of medium
$\mathbf{B} = \nabla \times \mathbf{A}$	[T]	Magnetic field
$\mathbf{A}$	$[\mathrm{T}\cdot\mathrm{m}]$	Magnetic vector potential
$\mathbf{M}_p$	$[\mathrm{A}\cdot\mathrm{m}^{-1}]$	Permanent magnetization of medium
	Strong form:	
	$\nabla \times \left(\frac{1}{\mu}\nabla \times \mathbf{A} - \frac{\mu_0}{\mu}\mathbf{M}_p\right) = \mathbf{J}$	
	Weak form:	
	$\int_\Omega \left(\frac{1}{\mu}\nabla \times \mathbf{A}\right)\cdot(\nabla \times \mathbf{W})\,d\Omega - \int_\Omega \frac{\mu_0}{\mu}\mathbf{M}_p\cdot(\nabla \times \mathbf{W})\,d\Omega + \int_{\Gamma_N}(\mathbf{n}\times\mathbf{H})\cdot\mathbf{W}\,d\Gamma_N - \int_\Omega \mathbf{J}\cdot\mathbf{W}\,d\Omega = 0$	
$\mathbf{n}\times\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{0}$ (or $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{0}$)	on Γ_D, homogeneous Dirichlet (tangent $\mathbf{B}$; tangent $\mathbf{H}$ when tangent $\mathbf{M}_p$)	
$\mathbf{n}\times\mathbf{H} = \mathbf{0}$	on Γ_N, homogeneous Neumann (normal $\mathbf{H}$; normal $\mathbf{B}$ when normal $\mathbf{M}_p$)	
$\mathbf{n}\times\mathbf{H} = -\mathbf{K}_N(\mathbf{r})$	on Γ_N, nonhomogeneous Neumann (prescribed surface current density)	
$\mathbf{n}\times\mathbf{H} = \mathbf{A}_t/(\mu_0 R)$	on Γ_N, first order asymptotic boundary ($\mathbf{A}_t$ is tangential component)	
	Post-processing:	
$W_H = \frac{1}{2}\int \mu H^2\,d\Omega$	[J]	Magnetostatic energy
$W_B = \frac{1}{2}\int \frac{1}{\mu}B^2\,d\Omega$	[J]	Magnetostatic coenergy (equal to energy when $\mathbf{M}_p = \mathbf{0}$)

The following graph shows the modeling of a linear permanent magnet in the second quadrant of the *BH* plane.



5 Electrokinetics – Scalar potential

It is assumed that the $\sigma \mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{B}$ term can be neglected in the current density (only $\sigma \mathbf{E}$ remains).

	Governing law:	
	$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{J} = 0$	
$\mathbf{J}$	$[\mathrm{A} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-2}]$	Current density
	Constitutive relation:	
	$\mathbf{J} = \sigma \mathbf{E}$	
σ	$[\Omega^{-1} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-1}]$	Electric conductivity of medium (inverse of resistivity)
$\mathbf{E} = -\nabla V$	$[\mathrm{V} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-1}]$	Electric field
V	[V]	Electric potential
	Strong form:	
	$\nabla \cdot (\sigma \nabla V) = 0$	
	Weak form:	
	$\int_\Omega \sigma \nabla V \cdot \nabla W \, d\Omega + \int_{\Gamma_N} \mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{J} \, W \, d\Gamma_N = 0$	
$V = V_D$	on Γ_D, constant Dirichlet (normal $\mathbf{J}$ and $\mathbf{E}$); current I [A] is the associated (dual) global quantity for a floating potential	
$V = V_D(\mathbf{r})$	on Γ_D, nonhomogeneous Dirichlet (general case)	
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{J} = 0$	on Γ_N, homogeneous Neumann (tangent $\mathbf{J}$ and $\mathbf{E}$)	
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{J} = J_{n,N}(\mathbf{r})$	on Γ_N, nonhomogeneous Neumann (normal component of current density) (positive when current exits Ω, negative when current enters Ω)	
	Post-processing:	
$P = \int \sigma E^2 \, d\Omega$	[W]	Power loss (absorbed power, Joule loss)

The correspondance between the electrostatic scalar formulation (without free charges or permanent polarization) and the electrokinetic scalar formulation is

$$\mathbf{D} \leftrightarrow \mathbf{J} \qquad \varepsilon_0 \leftrightarrow \sigma \tag{4}$$

6 Thermal conduction – Scalar potential

The notation used below is a mix of those found in the *FEMM* software user manual and in the textbook "*A first course in finite elements*" by Fish and Belytschko.

		Governing law:
		$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{q} = s$
$\mathbf{q}$	$[\mathrm{W} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-2}]$	Heat flux density
s	$[\mathrm{W} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-3}]$	Volumetric heat source density
		Constitutive relation:
		$\mathbf{q} = k\mathbf{G}$
k	$[\mathrm{W} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-1} \cdot \mathrm{K}^{-1}]$	Thermal conductivity (sometimes denoted using λ)
$\mathbf{G} = -\nabla T$	$[\mathrm{K} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-1}]$	Negated temperature gradient
T	[K]	Temperature (can be [°C] when no radiation boundary)
		Strong form:
		$-\nabla \cdot (k \nabla T) = s$
		Weak form:
		$\int_\Omega k \nabla T \cdot \nabla W \, d\Omega + \int_{\Gamma_N} \mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{q} \, W \, d\Gamma_N - \int_\Omega s \, W \, d\Omega = 0$
$T = T_D$		on Γ_D, constant Dirichlet (normal $\mathbf{q}$ and $\mathbf{G}$); heat flux Q [W] is the associated (dual) global quantity for a floating temperature
$T = T_D(\mathbf{r})$		on Γ_D, nonhomogeneous Dirichlet (general case)
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{q} = 0$		on Γ_N, homogeneous Neumann (tangent $\mathbf{q}$ and $\mathbf{G}$)
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{q} = q_{n,N}(\mathbf{r})$		on Γ_N, nonhomogeneous Neumann (normal component of heat flux density) (positive when heat exits Ω, negative when heat enters Ω)
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{q} = (T - T_0)h$		on Γ_N, convection boundary with heat transfer coefficient h $[\mathrm{W} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-2} \cdot \mathrm{K}^{-1}]$
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{q} = (T^4 - T_0^4)\beta\sigma_{sb}$		on Γ_N, radiation boundary with emissivity factor β (generally $0 \le \beta \le 1$) and the Stefan Boltzmann constant σ_{sb}
		Post-processing:
$\dot{S}_p = \int kG^2/T^2 \, d\Omega$	$[\mathrm{W} \cdot \mathrm{K}^{-1}]$	Entropy production rate (assumes $T > 0$)

The correspondance between the electrostatic scalar formulation (without permanent polarization) and the themal conduction scalar formulation is

$$V \leftrightarrow T \qquad \varepsilon_0 \leftrightarrow k \qquad \rho \leftrightarrow s \qquad \mathbf{E} \leftrightarrow \mathbf{G} \qquad \mathbf{D} \leftrightarrow \mathbf{q} \tag{5}$$

7 Potential flow – Scalar potential

An inviscid, incompressible, irrotational fluid flow. Although the mass density is constant and has no effect on the main equations, the local conservation of mass is used as the governing law instead of the incompressibility condition $\nabla \cdot \mathbf{v} = 0$.

	Governing law:	
	$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{g} = 0$	
$\mathbf{g} = \rho\mathbf{v}$	$[\mathrm{kg} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-2} \cdot \mathrm{s}^{-1}]$	Momentum density
$\mathbf{v} = -\nabla\varphi$	$[\mathrm{m} \cdot \mathrm{s}^{-1}]$	Velocity
φ	$[\mathrm{m}^2 \cdot \mathrm{s}^{-1}]$	Velocity potential
ρ	$[\mathrm{kg} \cdot \mathrm{m}^{-3}]$	Mass density
	Strong form:	
	$\nabla \cdot (\rho\nabla\varphi) = 0$	
	Weak form 1:	
	$\int_\Omega \rho\nabla\varphi \cdot \nabla W \, d\Omega + \int_{\Gamma_N} \mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{g} \, W \, d\Gamma_N = 0$	
$\varphi = \varphi_D$	on Γ_D, constant Dirichlet (normal $\mathbf{g}$ and $\mathbf{v}$); mass flow rate $\dot{m}$ $[\mathrm{kg} \cdot \mathrm{s}^{-1}]$ is the associated (dual) global quantity for a floating potential	
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{g} = 0$	on Γ_N, homogeneous Neumann (tangent $\mathbf{g}$ or $\mathbf{v}$)	
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{g} = g_{n,N}(\mathbf{r})$	on Γ_N, nonhomogeneous Neumann (normal component of momentum density, positive when flow exits Ω, negative when flow enters Ω)	
	Weak form 2:	
	$\int_\Omega \nabla\varphi \cdot \nabla W \, d\Omega + \int_{\Gamma_N} \mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{v} \, W \, d\Gamma_N = 0$	
$\varphi = \varphi_D$	on Γ_D, constant Dirichlet (normal $\mathbf{g}$ and $\mathbf{v}$); volumetric flow rate Q $[\mathrm{m}^3 \cdot \mathrm{s}^{-1}]$ is the associated (dual) global quantity for a floating potential	
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{v} = 0$	on Γ_N, homogeneous Neumann (tangent $\mathbf{g}$ or $\mathbf{v}$)	
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{v} = v_{n,N}(\mathbf{r})$	on Γ_N, nonhomogeneous Neumann (normal component of velocity field, positive when flow exits Ω, negative when flow enters Ω)	
	Post-processing:	
$K = \frac{1}{2}\int \rho v^2 \, d\Omega$	[J]	Kinetic energy
$q = \frac{1}{2}\rho v^2$	[Pa]	Dynamic pressure (static pressure: $p = C - q$, where C is the constant in Bernoulli's equation)

The correspondance between the electrostatic scalar formulation (without free charges or permanent polarization) and the potential flow scalar formulation is

$$V \leftrightarrow \varphi \qquad \varepsilon_0 \leftrightarrow \rho \qquad \mathbf{E} \leftrightarrow \mathbf{v} \qquad \mathbf{D} \leftrightarrow \mathbf{g} \tag{6}$$

8 Magnetoquasistatics – Vector and scalar potentials

This formulation applies when the fields are not time-invariant, but the time derivative of the electric displacement field $\mathbf{D}$ is negligible compared to the free current density $\mathbf{J}$ in the Maxwell-Ampère law. This is a mixed formulation based on time-harmonic (phasor) extensions of the Electrokinetics and Magnetostatics formulations. Permanent magnetization is omitted. Test functions $\tilde{W}$ and $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}$ are assumed to be separate functions (i.e. the first is not the norm of the second). The domain Ω_c is the nonempty conducting subdomain of Ω where Eddy currents are present, the domain Ω_s is the possibly empty subdomain of Ω where an imposed current density $\tilde{\mathbf{J}}_s$ exists (no Eddy-currents), such that $\Omega_c \cap \Omega_s = 0$ and $\{\Omega_c \cup \Omega_s\} \subseteq \Omega$. Example use cases:

1. Skin effect: voltage/current sources are related to Ω_c, and Ω_s is empty ($\tilde{\mathbf{J}}_s$ is unused);
2. Induction heating: Ω_s is nonempty and contains a known current source $\tilde{\mathbf{J}}_s$ where induction effects are neglected (stranded conductors), no sources via voltage/current related to Ω_c, where induction occurs.

Governing laws:

$$\nabla \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{J}} = 0$$
$$\nabla \times \tilde{\mathbf{H}} = \tilde{\mathbf{J}}$$

Constitutive relations:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{J}} = \sigma \tilde{\mathbf{E}} + \tilde{\mathbf{J}}_s$$
$$\tilde{\mathbf{B}} = \mu \tilde{\mathbf{H}}$$

$\tilde{\mathbf{E}} = -\nabla \tilde{V} - i\omega \tilde{\mathbf{A}}$	$[\mathrm{V \cdot m^{-1}}]$	Electric field (i is the imaginary unit), in Ω_c
$\tilde{V},\ \tilde{\mathbf{A}}$	$[\mathrm{V},\ \mathrm{T \cdot m}]$	Scalar and vector potentials, in Ω_c and Ω respectively
ω	$[\mathrm{s^{-1}}]$	Angular frequency, where $\omega = 2\pi f$ and f is the frequency in Hz
$\tilde{\mathbf{J}}_s$	$[\mathrm{A \cdot m^{-2}}]$	Imposed source current density, in Ω_s, where $\nabla \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{J}}_s = 0$ assumed
$\tilde{\mathbf{B}} = \nabla \times \tilde{\mathbf{A}}$	[T]	Magnetic field, in Ω

Strong forms:

$$\nabla \cdot \left(\sigma \nabla \tilde{V}\right) + \nabla \cdot \left(i\omega\sigma \tilde{\mathbf{A}}\right) = 0$$
$$\nabla \times \left(\frac{1}{\mu} \nabla \times \tilde{\mathbf{A}}\right) = -\sigma \nabla \tilde{V} - i\omega\sigma \tilde{\mathbf{A}} + \tilde{\mathbf{J}}_s$$

Weak forms:

$$\int_{\Omega_c} \sigma \nabla \tilde{V} \cdot \nabla \tilde{W}\, d\Omega_c + \int_{\Omega_c} i\omega\sigma \tilde{\mathbf{A}} \cdot \nabla \tilde{W}\, d\Omega_c + \int_{\Gamma_{Nc}} \mathbf{n} \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{J}}\, \tilde{W}\, d\Gamma_{N_c} = 0$$

$$\int_{\Omega} \left(\frac{1}{\mu} \nabla \times \tilde{\mathbf{A}}\right) \cdot (\nabla \times \tilde{\mathbf{W}})\, d\Omega + \int_{\Omega_c} \sigma \nabla \tilde{V} \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{W}}\, d\Omega_c + \int_{\Omega_c} i\omega\sigma \tilde{\mathbf{A}} \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{W}}\, d\Omega_c - \int_{\Omega_s} \tilde{\mathbf{J}}_s \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{W}}\, d\Omega_s + \int_{\Gamma_N} (\mathbf{n} \times \tilde{\mathbf{H}}) \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{W}}\, d\Gamma_N = 0$$

$\tilde{V} = \tilde{V}_D$	on Γ_{D_c}, constant Dirichlet electrode potential; current $\tilde{I}$ [A] is the (dual) global quantity (normal $\tilde{\mathbf{J}}$; normal $\tilde{\mathbf{E}}$ when normal $\tilde{\mathbf{A}}$)
$\mathbf{n} \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{J}} = 0$	on Γ_{N_c}, homogeneous Neumann (tangent $\tilde{\mathbf{J}}$; tangent $\tilde{\mathbf{E}}$ when tangent $\tilde{\mathbf{A}}$)
$\mathbf{n} \times \tilde{\mathbf{A}} = \mathbf{0}$ (or $\tilde{\mathbf{A}} = \mathbf{0}$)	on Γ_D, homogeneous Dirichlet (tangent $\tilde{\mathbf{H}}$ and $\tilde{\mathbf{B}}$)
$\mathbf{n} \times \tilde{\mathbf{H}} = \mathbf{0}$	on Γ_N, homogeneous Neumann (normal $\tilde{\mathbf{H}}$ and $\tilde{\mathbf{B}}$)
$\mathbf{n} \times \tilde{\mathbf{H}} = \tilde{\mathbf{A}}_t/(\mu_0 R)$	on Γ_N, first order asymptotic boundary ($\tilde{\mathbf{A}}_t$ is tangential component)

Post-processing:

$P_c = \frac{1}{2} \int \sigma \tilde{\mathbf{E}} \cdot \tilde{\mathbf{E}}^*\, d\Omega_c$	[J]	Average real power, where * denotes the complex conjugate

A Symmetry and open boundaries in GetDP

The formulations given previously fall under two main types: the strong forms in the scalar potential formulations are of the *div(grad)* type, and the vector potential formulations are of the *curl(curl)* type. These formulations can be applied to 2D planar, 2D axisymmetric or 3D domains by employing the proper declarations in the `FunctionSpace` and `Jacobian` objects in GetDP, as shown further below. Consequently, the weak formulations require very little syntactical modifications when specified in the `Formulation` object in GetDP. The two main changes are: 1) the test functions appearing in the `Integral` terms (in the second argument of the inner product) use the same symbol as the unknown variable, and 2) vector source quantities should have components consisent with the chosen symmetry in 2D. For example, in a 2D simulation specified in the x,y plane in Gmsh (at $z = 0$), a current density should have a z component only, while permanent magnetization/polarization should have x,y components only. In 2D axisymmetric simulations, the x,y axes represent the r,z axes respectively.

In the table below, the "Type" column shows the function space to declare for each type of simulation. The "Function/Entity" column describes the first order basis functions that are minimally required. The "2nd order" column shows the additional basis functions needed to support second order interpolation[1], assuming that second order geometrical meshing was specified in the `.geo` file using:

```
Mesh.HighOrderOptimize = 2;  Mesh.ElementOrder = 2;
```

In the "2nd order" column, "None" means that no additional basis functions need to be explicitely added since they are automatically added when second order geometrical elements are used. It is possible to use second order interpolation on first order geometrical elements, but this is not covered here.

Function spaces and basis functions for scalar potential formulations

	Type	Function / Entity	2nd order
2D planar	`Form0`	`BF_Node` / `NodesOf`	None (automatic)
2D axisym.	`Form0`	`BF_Node` / `NodesOf`	None (automatic)
3D	`Form0`	`BF_Node` / `NodesOf`	None (automatic)

Function spaces and basis functions for vector potential formulations

	Type	Function / Entity	2nd order
2D planar	`Form1P`	`BF_PerpendicularEdge` / `NodesOf`	None (automatic)
2D axisym.	`Form1P`	`BF_PerpendicularEdge` / `NodesOf`	None (automatic)
3D	`Form1`	`BF_Edge` / `EdgesOf`	`BF_Edge_3F_a` / `FacetsOf` ★
			`BF_Edge_3F_b` / `FacetsOf` ★
			`BF_Edge_3F_c` / `FacetsOf` ★

★: add any two of these three (apply constraints also, but not tree/cotree gauging)

Jacobians are given in the table below for the main regions of dimension n of the simulation. The external Jacobian is used in the external region of open boundary models, when applicable. Only a selected set of Jacobians are listed, others can be found in the GetDP manual. The `Sur` Jacobian can be applied to regions of dimension $n-1$ in the 2D planar and 3D simulations, while the `SurAxi` Jacobian can be applied to 1D regions in 2D axisymmetrical simulations. It is also possible to use the `VolCylShell` Jacobian in the external region of a 2D planar simulation, but since it internally reverts to the `VolSphShell` Jacobian, it is more natural to use `VolSphShell` (which becomes 2D in this case).

[1] In the case of edge elements, the designation of interpolation order is more intricate (and actually different) than described here. In this work, it is assumed that a vector potential is being solved, and that the order designation follows that of the geometrical elements (i.e., that second order interpolation basis functions are said to be related to second order geometrical elements for the sake of simplicity).

Jacobians for main region, and external region when open boundary

	n	Jacobian	External Jacobian
2D planar	2	`Vol`	`VolSphShell`
2D axisym.	2	`VolAxi`	`VolAxiSphShell`
3D	3	`Vol`	`VolSphShell`, `VolCylShell`

The `Sur`, `SurAxi`, `Vol` and `VolAxi` Jacobians do not have any parameters. The first two parameters of the external Jacobians are the internal and external radii of the shell region. The default center point for the external Jacobians is $x = y = z = 0$, and the default axis for the `VolCylShell` Jacobian is z.

B Global basis functions in GetDP

This section presents a very short and incomplete summary of global basis functions in GetDP. For a more detailed description, see tutorial #6 in the GetDP user manual (version 4.0.0 or higher, or the development version until released).

Certain scalar potential formulations presented in this document mention a global quantity associated with a constant Dirichlet boundary condition. These global quantities can be linked to a special type of basis function in GetDP. When this is done, two options become available when imposing a constaint on a given global region. Using the electrostatics formulation as an example, the first case consists of an imposed Dirichlet constraint on the variable itself (electrostatic potential), which is nothing new; however, when the global approach is used, the associated global quantity that is automatically calculated is the total charge. Conversely, it is also possible to impose the associated global quantity (the total charge here), whereby the electric potential of the region will be automatically calculated; this corresponds to situation called "floating potential", since the potential is not known in advance. Another example is a Dirichlet boundary of constant temperature, where the heat flux across this boundary is the associated global quantity; imposing either one allows the calculation of the other.

To implement global quantities in GetDP, the nodes r of a region having a constant potential must be grouped into a separate basis function with Function/Entity keywords

`BF_GroupOfNodes` / `GroupsOfNodesOf[`r`];`

these same nodes must be excluded from the main region's basis function using

`BF_Node` / `NodesOf[All, Not` r`].`

A global quantity entry must also be added in the `FunctionSpace` object, to declare variables for the alias of the main unknown variable in the equation (voltage or temperature in the examples above), using `AliasOf`, and for the quantity associated with it (total charge or heat flux here), using `AssociatedWith`. A global term must also be added in the formulation (`GlobalTerm`).

C Weak form derivation notes

To obtain the weak forms, these main steps are followed.

For the scalar potential formulations:

1. Multiply the governing law by the test function W and integrate over Ω;
2. Apply the vector identity $W(\nabla \cdot \mathbf{F}) = \nabla \cdot (W\mathbf{F}) - \mathbf{F} \cdot (\nabla W)$ to the divergence term;
3. Invoke the divergence theorem $\int \nabla \cdot (W\mathbf{F})\, d\Omega = \int (W\mathbf{F}) \cdot \mathbf{n}\, d\Gamma$ on the first of the two resulting terms of the previous indentity, and rearrange to obtain an integrand of the form $(\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{F})\, W$;
4. Substitute any constitutive laws as required.

For the vector potential formulations:

1. Perform a dot product of the governing law and the test function $\mathbf{W}$ and integrate over Ω;
2. Apply the vector identity $\mathbf{W} \cdot (\nabla \times \mathbf{F}) = \nabla \cdot (\mathbf{F} \times \mathbf{W}) + \mathbf{F} \cdot (\nabla \times \mathbf{W})$ to the curl term;
3. Invoke the divergence theorem $\int \nabla \cdot (\mathbf{F} \times \mathbf{W})\, d\Omega = \int (\mathbf{F} \times \mathbf{W}) \cdot \mathbf{n}\, d\Gamma$ on the first of the two resulting terms of the previous indentity, and rearrange using a tripple product identity to obtain an integrand of the form $(\mathbf{n} \times \mathbf{F}) \cdot \mathbf{W}$;
4. Substitute any constitutive laws as required.